Chainsaw maintenance schedule

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For gas chainsaws on a working crew. The daily checks are mostly safety: the chain brake, the throttle lockout, and a chain that doesn't creep at idle.

Typical intervals from manufacturer manuals and published service schedules. Your machine's manual comes first.

Every day

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Look the whole saw over for damage and leaks	Daily		
Test throttle, throttle lockout and stop switch	Daily		
Test the chain brake	Daily		
Check the chain is getting oil	Daily	Point it at a stump and rev; you should see a line of oil	
Check chain sharpness and tension	Daily and every refuel		
Chain doesn't move at idle	Daily	Adjust idle if it creeps	
Clean the air intake and cylinder fins	As needed		

Weekly

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Check the sprocket	Weekly	Replace when worn	
Check the bar, file off burrs	Weekly	Flip the bar for even wear	
Sharpen the chain	Weekly at minimum	Daily in dirty wood	

Monthly and longer

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Clean the air filter	Monthly	Replace if damaged	
Replace the spark plug	Every 100 hours		
Decarbon the exhaust port	About every 150 hours	Shop job	
Chain brake serviced by a dealer	Every 3 months full-time, 6 part-time, 12 occasional		
New saws: re-tighten cylinder base screws	After the first 10 to 20 hours	Bigger professional saws	

Service log: chainsaw

Machine / unit: _____ Make & model: _____

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DATE	HOURS / DATE	WORK DONE	PARTS USED	INITIALS

Free printable from fleetoptima.org/maintenance-schedules